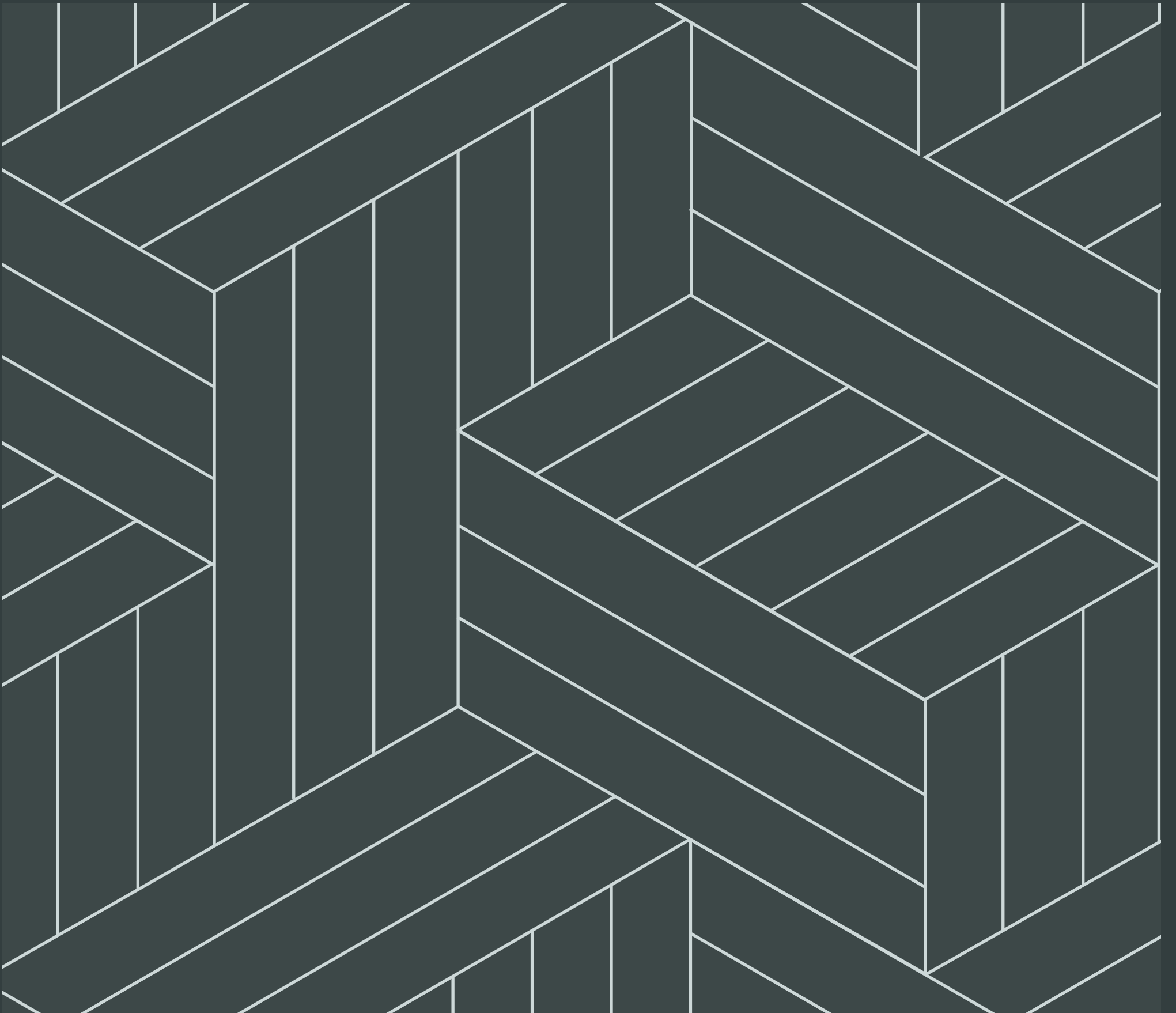




Harvey

# Building the Business Case for Legal AI — A Guide for In-House Teams

# Introduction

The pressure to do more with less is affecting business leaders across every function — and in-house legal is no exception. As Dr. Claudia Junker, General Counsel at Deutsche Telekom, put it: “Doing more with less is a constant reality.” Legal teams are being asked to streamline processes, cut costs, and move faster — all without compromising risk oversight or business support.



**Dr. Claudia Junker**  
General Counsel at Deutsche Telekom

AI is emerging as a core capability to help legal meet these demands. By increasing consistency, speed, and alignment with enterprise goals, legal AI is enabling a shift — from reactive legal support to proactive business enablement.

Still, many teams are asking: Where does AI actually fit into legal work — and how do we justify the investment?

As Weston Wicks, senior director analyst in the Gartner Assurance Practice, put it: “Legal departments will have to embrace these technologies to remain competitive and efficient.”

This guide was created for in-house legal professionals — especially General Counsels, Legal Ops leaders, and transformation champions — who are ready to make the case for AI, but need to bring key stakeholders with them. What follows is a practical framework for building momentum, showcasing impact, and reframing legal’s role as a driver of strategic value.

## Getting Started Tip

Identify one or two high-volume, repetitive legal tasks that slow your team down. Whether it’s reviewing standard contracts or triaging incoming requests, these areas are often the best place to demonstrate early wins — and build the foundation for broader AI adoption.

# Frame the Internal Conversation — What's Different About Legal AI?

From procurement to HR to finance, AI has entered the boardroom — and functions across the enterprise are using it to drive scalable digital transformation. The expectations are the same everywhere: handle more volume and complexity, faster, without increasing headcount or risk.

But not just any AI tool works for legal.

Legal work is substantively different — it's high-stakes, highly nuanced, and tightly regulated. The kinds of questions legal teams ask — and the consequences of getting them wrong — require a different level of reasoning, context, and confidentiality than what general-purpose tools are built for.

## Don't let legal be left behind

Legal AI isn't just about internal productivity. It's a way to reduce the bottlenecks that slow down business, enable smarter, faster decision-making, and position legal as a driver of growth — in line with enterprise priorities.

Generative AI is particularly well-suited to legal because, “generative AI — being rooted in text analysis — is a good fit technology for reshaping the legal department by automating routine tasks and providing deeper insights,” said Weston Wicks, senior director analyst in the Gartner Assurance Practice. “The implications are significant, as GenAI can enable legal departments to allocate resources more efficiently and focus more employee time on strategic initiatives.”

According to published Gartner research, the top six high-value, high-feasibility use cases for GenAI in legal departments are:

1. Contract visibility and data extraction
2. Automated contract review
3. Summarization of legal documents
4. Legal intake and triage
5. Transcription and summarization of meetings
6. Contract risk analysis

*(All Gartner references in this guide are drawn from the firm's published research and analysis as an independent advisory source.)*

These aren't theoretical — they're already being implemented across leading legal departments. Falling behind in these areas means missing the opportunity to deliver faster, more strategic legal support to the business — and highlights exactly why legal needs purpose-built AI.



## Why legal needs purpose-built AI

Off-the-shelf AI tools may serve general business functions — but legal work is different. These five realities explain why legal teams require tools specifically designed for the complexity, sensitivity, and strategic nature of their role.

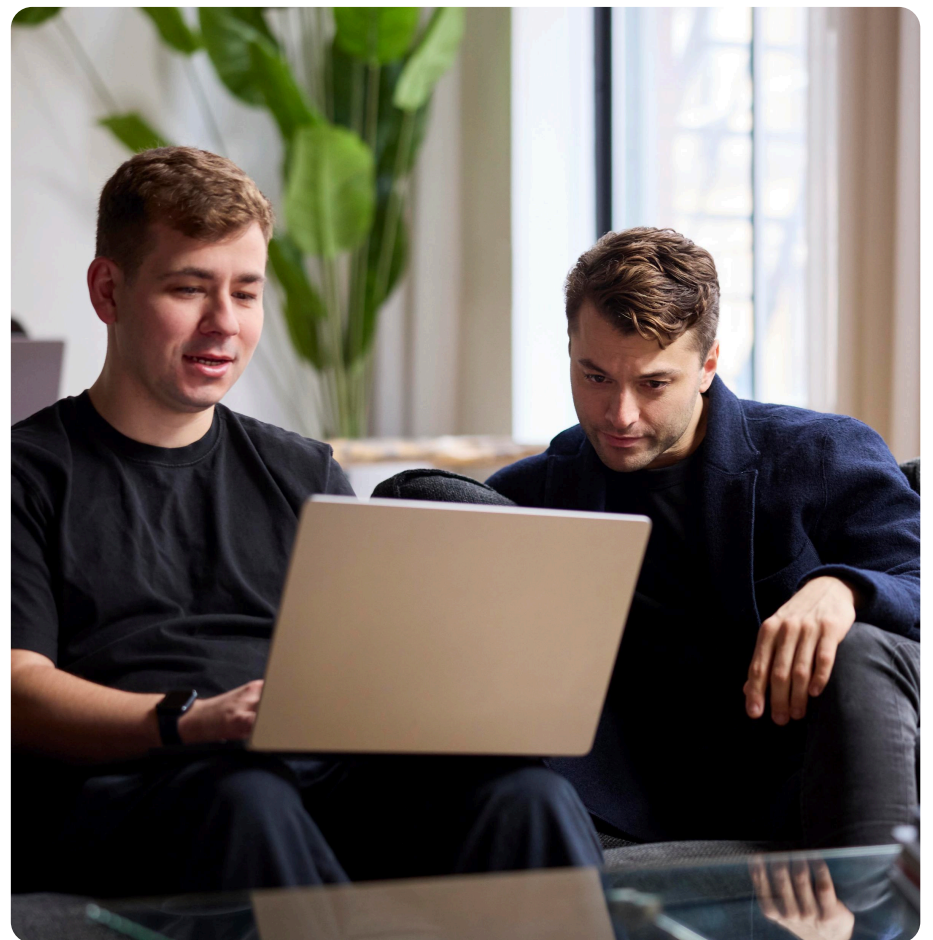
**The expectations are different:** Legal isn't just a support function — it's a strategic partner. Legal teams need tools that help them move faster, *without sacrificing rigor*, and collaborate more effectively across the business and with outside counsel.

**The work is sensitive:** Legal touches confidential transactions, employment matters, intellectual property, and regulatory risk. Generic AI tools often lack the security, governance, and review controls required for legal work.

**The content is complex:** Legal reasoning goes far beyond pattern-matching. It requires deep contextual understanding — of language, facts, jurisdiction, and precedent. Legal AI must be able to reference and reason across internal knowledge (such as prior matters, templates, and clause libraries) as well as authoritative sources like statutes, case law, and regulations — and present outputs that reflect both.

**The risks are real:** Mistakes in legal contexts can lead to regulatory breaches, financial penalties, and reputational harm. That's why tools with unclear training data, no ability to show citations, or inconsistent outputs often don't meet legal's threshold for trust.

**It has to meet legal teams where they work:** Legal AI should support the way teams already work — not the other way around. That means integrating with familiar systems such as document management or knowledge work platforms, CLMs, and Microsoft Office, while also enabling seamless collaboration across locations, devices, and workflows. The most effective platforms connect people, documents, and processes, so legal professionals can stay aligned and contribute wherever they are — whether in the office, in court, or alongside business partners.





# How Leading Teams are Getting Started

Across industries, forward-looking legal departments are applying AI in targeted ways — from improving workflows to aligning more closely with business priorities. Many have deployed legal-specific platforms, including tools like Harvey, to support their internal teams, enhance collaboration, and reduce friction in day-to-day work.

The examples that follow reflect a range of starting points — from innovation-driven pilots to enterprise rollouts — and demonstrate how legal teams are finding early momentum with AI by focusing on the use cases that matter most.

## 1. Positioning for Innovation

Teams operating in innovation-driven environments are embedding AI into legal workflows as part of broader transformation strategies. In doing so, they're making the most of their organizations' time and talent — streamlining routine tasks, accelerating deal velocity, reducing external spending, and supporting growth while staying compliant.

One of the world's largest asset managers, Bridgewater Associates built an AI working group that included legal, procurement, compliance, and technology partners. Together, they identified high-impact use cases and accelerated adoption across the organization. Today, the legal team uses Harvey to free attorneys from routine tasks and align legal's role with the firm's culture of operational excellence.

### BRIDGEWATER

With Harvey, Bridgewater reports seeing 95%+ time savings on large-scale agreement reviews and, in one instance, cut a vendor contract review from an average of two days to just two hours.

Repsol, a global multi-energy company headquartered in Spain, integrated Harvey into its legal department as part of its digital transformation strategy. Over 150 lawyers across Repsol now use Harvey for document analysis, comparisons, translations, and summary generation — saving an average of three hours per week per attorney and enabling more time for high-value legal work.



"The implementation of Harvey positions Repsol's lawyers at the forefront of the legal profession's digital transformation."

**Pablo Blanco Pérez**  
General Counsel

## 2. Tying AI to Strategic Business Value

Legal teams are using AI to reduce friction, improve time-to-business, and support enterprise goals. The most effective initiatives position AI as a lever for broader business outcomes — not just internal efficiency. By framing adoption in terms of enterprise priorities such as faster revenue recognition, reduced regulatory risk, and more consistent client support, legal can show its value as a business enabler.

### Comcast

As part of its legal transformation, Comcast introduced Harvey to help lawyers reduce turnaround time and deliver more consistent, business-aligned legal support.

### Deutsche Telekom

Europe's largest telecom provider deployed Harvey to manage regulatory complexity and high-volume contract work without compromising service quality.

### Dentsu

A global marketing and advertising leader, Dentsu's legal team uses AI to accelerate contracting and support faster revenue recognition.

#### **dentsu**

“Speed to contract means speed to cash. Innovation is about removing friction so we can serve clients faster.”

Alison Malin Zoellner  
Group General Counsel

## 3. Showing Tangible Efficiency Gains

Pilot programs focused on core legal tasks are helping teams demonstrate early wins and justify broader rollout. By measuring outcomes from the start — such as hours saved, accuracy of outputs, user adoption, and ease of use — legal teams can capture concrete efficiency gains that build momentum for scaling.

### HubSpot

This global software company uses Harvey across legal operations — including redlining, research, and matter management — to improve collaboration and productivity.

### ASML

The Dutch semiconductor leader piloted 30+ AI use cases. Using Harvey and other AI tools, the legal team cut time spent on compliance and research by 15–20%, with greater time savings in complex areas.

#### **ASML**

“For tasks that involve extra levels of research, the time saved is way more.”

Antonello Gargano  
Head of Legal & Compliance Ops  
ASML

## 4. Strengthening Collaboration Across the Legal Ecosystem

Legal collaboration happens across multiple dimensions: in-house teams with specialized law firms, partners with associates, and teams spread across practice areas and jurisdictions. Yet critical inefficiencies often plague these workflows — delays from multi-step review cycles, system incompatibilities that break formatting, communication breakdowns across email threads, and fragmented workflows that force teams to toggle between documents, calls, and chats.

Harvey is uniquely designed to streamline these collaborations by connecting people, knowledge, and workflows across the systems legal teams already use — from document management and knowledge repositories to the Microsoft suite. Instead of juggling disconnected tools, teams can review, edit, and share legal work more fluidly — ensuring consistency, speed, and higher-quality outcomes.

### The Adecco Group

The Adecco Group, a global leader in HR and workforce solutions, has applied Harvey to optimize communication workflows across its Legal and Compliance teams — from internal memoranda to legal advice emails and critical correspondence. By streamlining these communications, Adecco has been able to collaborate more effectively across teams and jurisdictions, while reinforcing both efficiency and quality in its legal outputs.





# How to Address Common Concerns and Skepticism

Even leading legal teams have had to overcome questions about confidentiality, hype, and internal disruption. In fact, as one COO from an AmLaw100 firm observed in a recent [Harvard Law School study](#), “AI is a catalyst to begin new conversations regarding our business model.” That’s the opportunity: use skepticism as a prompt to engage, educate, and lead.

The best way to push forward is to anticipate objections — and reframe them with clear examples, credible context, and signals from peers and industry analysts. In addition to concerns about hype or job displacement, legal teams should be prepared to address questions around vendor risk, data protection, and human oversight — especially when AI is used in high-stakes matters.

For example, teams may need to confirm that AI vendors provide robust security and compliance documentation, and that outputs are always subject to legal review before being relied on in material decisions.

## Tip: Establish a Feedback Loop

Whether you're piloting or scaling, regular feedback is essential. A structured loop allows you to surface issues early, adjust quickly, and reinforce internal trust — all while identifying champions who can help make the case.

## Common Concerns and How Leading Teams Are Responding

### “Is AI just hype?”

A [2025 Harvard study of AmLaw100 firms](#) reports productivity gains up to 100x. [Gartner calls GenAI “table stakes” for Legal](#). AI isn’t hype — it’s becoming legal infrastructure.

### “Will this compromise confidentiality or compliance?”

Legal teams are already collaborating on AI platforms with secure review processes and strong governance. The key is choosing tools built for the legal team’s requirements.

### “Will AI replace legal professionals?”

AI frees teams from repetitive work — enabling more focus on strategic counsel. Legal professionals remain essential, and those with AI fluency are in high demand.

### “Will this strain relationships with outside counsel?”

[90% of AmLaw100 firms say AI will enhance client service](#). Co-developing use cases is helping in-house teams reduce cost and improve alignment with their law firms.

# Making the Case — A Framework for Getting Buy In

You don't need a perfect business case to get started.

The most effective in-house champions begin with a focused effort, build internal support through early momentum, and expand from there. This framework outlines how legal teams are moving forward — with practical steps that help demonstrate value, build trust, and open the door to broader adoption.

## 1. Start small

Pilot a focused use case with a cross-functional team. Bring in legal operations and tech partners early to shape adoption. [See HubSpot](#)

## 2. Align with business priorities

Frame your initiative in terms the business already cares about — whether that's speed, simplicity, innovation, or managing risk. [See Dentsu](#)

## 3. Identify promising use cases

Start where AI can relieve pressure quickly — like reviewing standard contracts, summarizing key docs, or answering common research questions. [See ASML](#)

## 4. Engage key stakeholders early

Involve compliance, IT, procurement, and information security early in the process. Early alignment smooths the path for broader rollout. [See Bridgewater](#)

## 5. Shape the narrative

Position legal as a proactive enabler — a team using AI responsibly to support better decisions, not just chasing efficiency. [See Repsol](#)

## 6. Collaborate across the legal ecosystem

Look for opportunities to use AI in ways that strengthen collaboration — whether that's with law firm partners, across business units, or between teams in different jurisdictions. Shared successes not only reduce friction in day-to-day work, but also demonstrate the broader value of legal AI to the business. [See The Adecco Group](#).



Pablo Blanco Perez,  
General Counsel, Repsol



# Conclusion

Adoption of Legal AI is no longer a question of *if* — but *how*. Across industries, in-house legal teams are taking pragmatic, forward-looking steps to explore what AI can do for their workflows, partnerships, and strategic value. Whether you’re responding to cost pressure, capacity constraints, or a broader transformation agenda, the opportunity is the same: to lead the conversation, not wait for it.

You don’t need to start big. You just need to start thoughtfully.

Issues like data handling, model training, vendor risk, human oversight, and ongoing governance should all be part of the evaluation process — not just as best practices, but as standards increasingly expected by regulators, enterprise stakeholders, and clients alike. Our next guide, [7 Key Criteria for Evaluating AI Solutions for Law](#), explores these dimensions in detail — helping legal teams choose a partner that is not only innovative, but trustworthy and aligned with Legal’s responsibilities.

